



MBA Rock

Brand Book

FIRST EDITION • 2026

For internal + partner use

About this brand book

This is the working document for how MBA Rock looks, sounds, and shows up — across web, print, social, partner co-brand, and every operator artifact in between.

The brand exists for a single reason: to make business mastery accessible to anyone who can listen, read, and ship. Everything in here flows from that mission. If a color, a font, or a sentence drifts from that — change it.

Use this book like a working tool. Lift the swatches. Paste the type scale. Run drafts past the voice rules. Build new things in the same family.

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S E C T I O N 0 1

The Name

*"MBA" = Musical Business Album.
Not Music. Not Master of Business. The word holds the joke and
the curriculum.*

What MBA Rock is

MBA Rock is a full-length business curriculum delivered as a music album — 10 modules, 74 lessons, 74 original songs, one capstone, and a real plan you finish with.

THE NAME DECODED

MBA = Musical Business Album. The letter sequence is the joke and the answer. We never refer to it as "Master of Business" anything — that confuses partners and triggers regulatory concerns (we are not an accredited graduate degree program; partner institutions are).

We also never refer to it as "Music Business Album" — close, but the music isn't the topic; business is. Music is the delivery.

Rock = the genre, the verb, and the attitude. We rock — as in, we ship; we rock — as in, the songs are real songs you can play in the car; we rock — as in, the operator-energy of doing the work instead of talking about it.

Together: a complete business education that listens like an album, reads like a textbook, runs like a course, and ends with you holding a real plan for your business.

THE MISSION, IN ONE SENTENCE

Make business mastery accessible to anyone who can listen, read, and ship.

THE THREE AUDIENCES

1. **The Operator** — running a business right now, learning while shipping.
2. **The Aspiring Founder** — pre-launch, picking up the operating system before they need it.
3. **The Institutional Partner** — accredited university, corporate L&D, or alumni network co-branding MBA Rock under their accreditation umbrella.

S E C T I O N 0 2

Logo System

*A wordmark, a mark, and a co-brand lockup.
That's it. Everything else is decoration.*

The wordmark

"MBA Rock" set in Georgia, weight 800, letter-spacing -2 to -3pt, with an orange underline ornament four points tall. This is the primary brand mark — it should appear at the top of every owned surface.



MBA Rock

THE MUSICAL BUSINESS ALBUM



MBA
Rock

THE MUSICAL BUSINESS ALBUM

PRIMARY MARK

Use the wordmark in **Cream on Navy** as the default. Light variant (**Navy on Cream**) is the backup. The orange underline is non-negotiable — it's the visual anchor that ties every surface back to the brand.

Clear space + minimum size

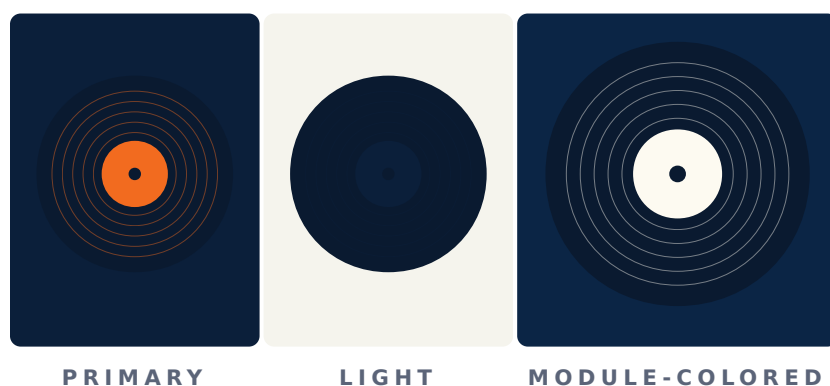
Give the wordmark room to breathe. The clear space around it is one "M-height" on every side.



MINIMUM SIZES

- **Digital:** 96px wide (wordmark) / 32px (vinyl mark)
- **Print:** 1.5in wide (wordmark) / 0.4in (vinyl mark)
- **Below those sizes:** Use the vinyl mark alone — never the wordmark at illegible size

THE VINYL MARK



The vinyl-record mark stands in for the wordmark when space is tight (favicon, app icon, social avatar, watermark). It's never used **next to** the wordmark — only as an alternative.

S E C T I O N 03

Color

*Three core colors do all the work.
Ten module accents do the wayfinding.*

Primary palette

Three colors carry the brand. Use them in this hierarchy: Navy is the foundation, Cream is the page, Orange is the spark.



HEX #0B1F3A · **RGB** 11 31 58 ·
CMYK 100 80 40 50
Use for: Backgrounds, headlines,
primary type on light pages

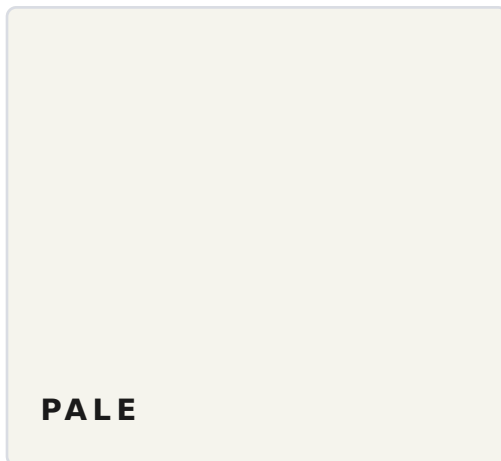


HEX #F26B1F · **RGB** 242 107 31 ·
CMYK 0 70 90 0
Use for: CTAs, key numbers, the
underline ornament, accent strokes

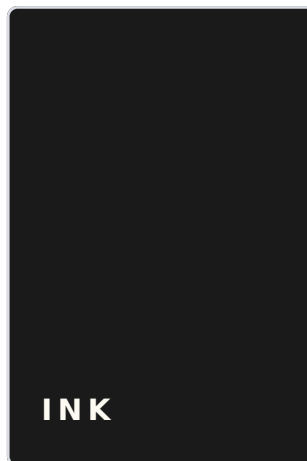


HEX #FDFAF1 · **RGB** 253 250 241 ·
CMYK 0 1 5 0
Use for: Page backgrounds, type
on navy, the soft surfaces

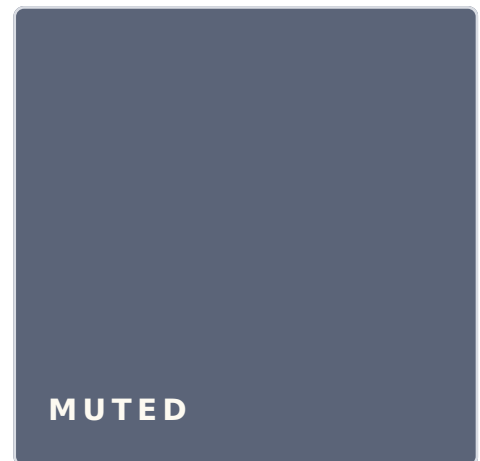
SUPPORTING NEUTRALS



HEX #F5F4ED
Section blocks, sidebars, quiet surfaces



HEX #1a1a1a
Body text on light pages



HEX #5b6478
Secondary copy, captions, meta info

FUNCTIONAL ACCENTS



HEX #2ec07a

Success, completion, "you got it"



HEX #c5364c

Common traps, errors, "don't" callouts

Module palette

Each of the 10 modules has its own accent color. Used in lesson headers, module openers, illustrations, and certificates so members navigate the course by color as much as by name.

M 1 Finance Fundamentals #0B2545	M 2 Strategy & Competitive Advantage #1A3A6B	M 3 People & Leadership #8B1A1A	M 4 Unit Economics & Growth Metrics #1A5C2A	M 5 Operations & Technology #4A1A6B
M 6 Growth & Capital #6B3A0B	M 7 Marketing & Brand #F26B1F	M 8 Operations & Execution #475569	M 9 Analytics & Decision Making #3B4F8C	M 10 Innovation & Future #A88735

HOW TO USE MODULE COLOR

- **Always paired with the wordmark.** Module color never replaces brand color — it accents it.
- **Lesson header bands** use the module color as the underline stroke and the lesson-number type.
- **Illustrations** use the module color as the primary fill; orange remains the spark accent.
- **Capstone certificates** use the module color of the section being certified.
- **Never use one module's color on another module's surface.** That breaks the wayfinding.

S E C T I O N 0 4

Typography

*A serif that does the talking. A sans that does the labeling.
Two faces. No exceptions.*

The type pair

Georgia (or its higher-fidelity sibling Fraunces, when licensed) for display and body prose. Inter for everything functional — labels, buttons, captions, numbers.

DISPLAY & BODY • GEORGIA / FRAUNCES (SERIF)

The MBA delivered as an album.

"Profit is opinion. Cash is fact." — Lesson M1L1

USE FOR: All headlines • body prose • pull quotes • book copy

FUNCTIONAL • INTER (SANS-SERIF)

Module 1 • Finance Fundamentals

All ten modules • 74 lessons • lifetime access • founders' rate \$499

JOIN AT FOUNDERS' RATE →

USE FOR: Labels • buttons • captions • numbers • UI text • section eyebrows

TYPE SCALE (RECOMMENDED)

DISPLAY 96

Cover & hero

H1 38PT

Section openers

H2 24PT

Lesson titles

**H3 11PT ALL-
CAPS**

SECTION HEADERS

BODY 10.5PT

Default body copy across the textbook and member surfaces.

UI 9.5PT

Inter for buttons, labels, captions, and meta lines.

CAPTION 8.5PT

Figure captions, footer text, page numbers.

PULL-QUOTE TREATMENT

Pull quotes are set in Georgia italic, 16pt, weight 600, with an orange quotation mark in the left margin (size 36pt). The block has a 6pt orange left border with a pale-cream gradient fade.

S E C T I O N 0 5

Voice & Tone

*Direct. Specific. Operator-flavored.
No theater, no jargon, no startup clichés.*

Voice principles

MBA Rock sounds like an operator who's done the work and is now telling you what they wish they'd known. Confident, specific, kind, and short.

THE FIVE PRINCIPLES

1. **Direct over diplomatic.** Say the thing. The reader does not need three paragraphs of throat-clearing.
2. **Specific over abstract.** "A 1% price increase, holding volume constant, drops directly to profit." Beats "Pricing has high leverage."
3. **Memorable over comprehensive.** The chorus wins. If a line is so long no one remembers it, cut it.
4. **Operator over MBA.** We don't talk like a case-study professor; we talk like a founder at a kitchen table at 11pm.
5. **Honest about limits.** The certificate is not an accredited degree; the trial is not for everyone; the course is not a guarantee. Honesty compounds.

VOCABULARY — DO / DON'T

USE

Operator · capstone · the dossier
· ship · lesson · module · cohort ·
partner · the album · sample ·
founders' rate

AVOID

Student · graduate · MBA program · degree ·
accredited (unless paired with partner
institution) · disrupt · synergy · gamify · learn-
by-doing · transform · empower · journey

SENTENCE SHAPE

DO

"Cash is the money in the bank — and only the money in the bank."

"Hire slow. Fire fast. Both halves matter."

"You finish this course with a real plan, not a certificate of attendance."

DON'T

"In this module, learners will explore the multifaceted dynamics of cash flow management in modern enterprises..."

"Our methodology empowers operators to unlock transformational growth potential..."

"Join thousands of professionals who have leveraged the MBA Rock journey..."

THE "MBA ROCK TEST"

Read the sentence out loud. If you'd never say it to a friend at dinner, rewrite it. If you can't fit it on a t-shirt eventually, it's probably too long.

S E C T I O N 0 6

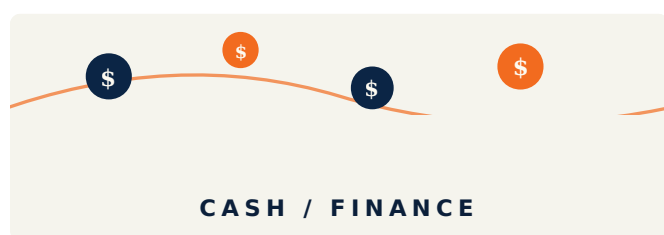
Imagery & Illustration

*Editorial-style vector illustration.
No stock photos. No realistic depictions of people.*

The illustration system

Every lesson and section gets an original conceptual illustration in the brand palette + the module's accent color. Bold shapes. Limited color. No realism.

The library covers 16+ concept types — money flow, paths, abstract teams, scales, charts, megaphones, gears, lightbulbs, blocks, clocks, compasses, networks, doors, funnels, rockets, handshakes, brain circuits, branching paths. New illustrations should fit the same family: 2–3 colors max, geometric primitives, no gradients beyond a single brand gradient.



RULES FOR NEW ILLUSTRATIONS

- **Geometric primitives only:** circles, rectangles, polygons, paths. No realistic rendering.
- **Two color minimum:** the module's accent + orange (or navy). Use cream / pale for backgrounds.
- **One spark element:** a single orange dot or stroke that draws the eye.
- **No people with faces.** Abstract silhouettes only. Never specific identifiable individuals.
- **No copyrighted iconography.** No brand logos, no recognizable products, no famous-painting references.
- **SVG over raster.** All illustrations ship as vector so they scale to any print size.

NO STOCK PHOTOS

MBA Rock does not use stock photography. The editorial illustration system replaces what would otherwise be stock — every surface stays in one family, no licensing concerns, infinitely reusable.

SECTION 07

Iconography & Marks

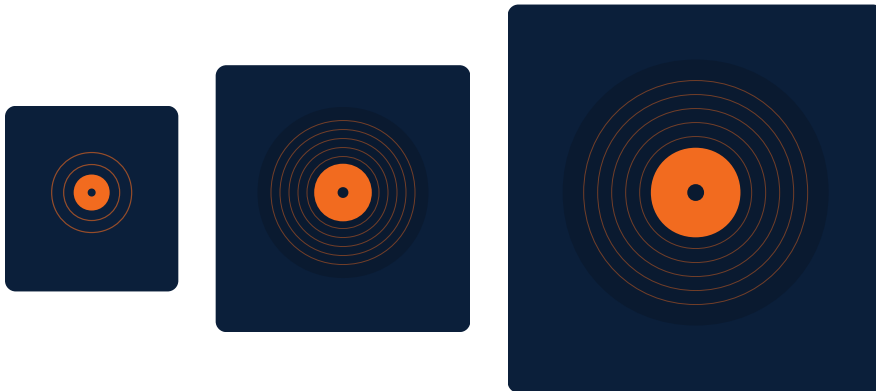
*The vinyl record is the constant.
Everything else is a variant of it.*

Marks & secondary devices

Beyond the wordmark, three repeating visual devices show up everywhere: the vinyl record (the genre mark), the orange underline (the wordmark anchor), and the QR code (the audio bridge from print to song).

THE VINYL RECORD

The mark of the brand. Used at every scale from favicon to full-page graphic. Composed of concentric circles + a solid center dot. Color is either orange (primary), cream (light), or the module color (modular surfaces).



THE ORANGE UNDERLINE

A 4pt orange bar, 60–80pt wide, placed under the wordmark and under section-opener H1s. It's the visual punctuation of the brand. Never use it under body text — that breaks the hierarchy.



THE QR CODE

Every printed lesson page carries a QR code linking to that lesson's audio file at [mbarock.com/audio/\[slug\].mp3](https://mbarock.com/audio/[slug].mp3). QR codes are always navy on white, 0.6in × 0.6in minimum, with a 6pt cream border. They live in the "Listen to the Song" strip — never floating in body copy.

SECTION EYEBROWS

Inter, 9pt, weight 800, letter-spacing 4pt, all caps, in either Navy or the module's accent color. They sit above H1s and inside callout blocks.

DEEP DIVE · CORE CONCEPTS · TAKE ACTION · QUIZ

S E C T I O N 0 8

Layout & Grid

*Generous white space.
Editorial pacing.*

Layout principles

MBA Rock surfaces — web pages, lesson pages, the textbook — share a layout DNA: generous side margins, two-column where the content is narrow, single-column where it's wide, and visual breakpoints (figures, pull quotes, callouts) every 600–800 words.

WEB GRID

- **Max content width:** 720px for prose, 1080px for grids and dashboards
- **Side gutter:** 24px mobile, 48px tablet, 80px desktop
- **Vertical rhythm:** 24px baseline grid; section spacing 48–80px

PRINT GRID (TEXTBOOK)

- **Trim:** 8.5 × 11 in (US Letter)
- **Margins:** 0.75in all sides; 0.55in on cover/section-divider full-bleeds
- **Body column:** single-column, justified, 10.5pt Georgia / 1.5 leading
- **Section-opener pages:** right-hand (recto) start, with intentional blank versos

THE "LESSON RHYTHM"

Every lesson — in the textbook or on the web — follows the same eight-block rhythm so members navigate by muscle memory. Different lesson, same shape.

1. Lesson header (ID + title + module subline)
2. Editorial banner illustration
3. Song strip with QR code
4. Deep Dive (prose, with embedded pull quote)
5. Lesson figure (chart, framework, or concept card)
6. Core Concepts (numbered list)
7. Common Traps (red-bordered callout)
8. Take Action → From the Studio sidebar → Quiz → Related Lessons

S E C T I O N 0 9

Co-brand Lockup

*MBA Rock × Partner.
An "×" is the only connector we use.*

The co-brand lockup

*When MBA Rock partners with an accredited institution or a corporate buyer, the lockup follows the same pattern: **MBA Rock** × **[Partner]** — with the orange "×" as the visual hinge.*

MBA Rock × Bushnell

MBA Rock × Liberty Online

BA Rock × Teach for Ameri

LOCKUP RULES

1. **MBA Rock is on the left.** Always.
2. **The connector is always "×".** Not "&", not "+", not "and", not "with".
3. **"×" is set in orange.** The only colored character in the lockup.
4. **Partner name is set in the same weight as MBA Rock.** Never larger; partners are equal but never lead.

5. **Underline lives under the "×" only**, 3pt orange, ~220pt wide — anchoring the partnership.
6. **One partner per lockup**. Triple-partner lockups (× A × B × C) are never used. If three parties exist, name them in body copy.

USAGE PROTECTION

The co-brand lockup is only generated on signed-partner surfaces (term sheet, definitive agreement, co-branded landing page). It is not used in marketing or outreach until the partnership is signed.

S E C T I O N 10

Application

*Web · Print · Social · Partner.
One brand, four surfaces.*

Web application

The marketing site (Squarespace, www.mbarock.com) and the course (GitHub Pages CDN, learn.mbarock.com) are the two web surfaces. Both share the same brand chassis.

MARKETING SITE (SQUARESPACE)

- **Hero:** Navy background, cream wordmark + orange underline, headline in Georgia 60–96pt, subhead in Inter 16–20pt
- **Sections alternate:** Navy → Cream → Pale → Navy. Never two navy sections in a row.
- **CTAs:** Orange button, cream text, all-caps Inter 14pt, ~18pt letter-spacing on the button label

COURSE (CDN)

- **Dashboard:** Cream background, navy nav, orange CTAs, module-colored progress chips
- **Lesson takeover:** Cream background, module-colored header band, vinyl mark in the navigation, song player as a fixed orange strip
- **Member gate:** Navy gradient background, cream wordmark + underline, orange "Unlock" CTA

Print application

The textbook is the flagship print artifact. The Partner Term Sheet, Operator Dossier export, and Capstone certificate live in the same family.

THE TEXTBOOK

- **Trim:** 8.5 × 11 in
- **Cover:** Navy with orange EQ-bar pattern + vinyl record + wordmark
- **Section dividers:** Full-bleed navy pages with generative artwork
- **Lesson rhythm:** 8-block lesson layout (see §08)

OPERATOR DOSSIER (PDF AUTO-GENERATED)

- **Cover:** Member's name + venture + Operator Dossier wordmark + MBA Rock signature footer
- **Sections:** 10 capstone sections in module color order
- **Footer on every page:** "Prepared via MBA Rock · mbarock.com"

CAPSTONE CERTIFICATE

- **Format:** Landscape 11 × 8.5 in or letter-sized portrait
- **Border:** 0.5in cream margin, 4pt orange rule inside the margin
- **Mark:** Wordmark top center; vinyl record top-right as a watermark
- **Body:** "This certifies that [Name] has completed [Module/Capstone]" in Georgia italic
- **Signature:** Josh's printed signature + "CEO, MBA Rock" caption

Social application

Square and vertical formats: Instagram feed (1:1), Instagram/TikTok stories (9:16), LinkedIn feed (1.91:1), Twitter/X feed (1.91:1).

STANDARD SOCIAL TILE RECIPE

1. **Background:** Navy or cream (alternate per post for variety)
2. **Quote:** Georgia 32–44pt, italic, no quotation marks (use them only in pull-out quotes)
3. **Source attribution:** Inter 10pt all-caps, letter-spacing 3pt — "MBA ROCK · LESSON M1L1"
4. **Brand footer:** Wordmark or vinyl mark, bottom-right, ~10% of canvas height
5. **Single orange accent:** An underline, a dot, a corner stripe — one accent per tile

STORY FORMAT (9:16)

Vertical orientation makes the wordmark hard to use full-width. Either rotate the wordmark 90° as a side anchor, or substitute the vinyl mark in the top-left and end with a "Listen at mbarock.com" CTA at the bottom.

WATERMARK POLICY

Every social tile carries the wordmark or vinyl mark — never both, never neither. No exceptions for "clean look" tiles.

S E C T I O N 11

Don'ts

Hard rules. The shortest path to off-brand is on this page.

What we don't do

Read this section twice. These are the rules that get violated most often in the first 90 days of a new partner or contractor working on the brand.

✗ **Never call it "Music Business Album."**

It's **Musical Business Album**. The L is non-negotiable. "Music" makes it sound like a curriculum about the music industry. It's not.

✗ **Never call it an MBA degree.**

MBA = Musical Business Album. The Operator's Certificate is a certificate of completion, not an accredited degree. Implying otherwise = federal + state fraud risk.

✗ **Never offer a free trial to D2C members or cohorts.**

The only allowed trial is the 7-day single-account evaluation seat for corporate or institutional buyers. The free sample at /sample is not a trial — it's a sample.

✗ **Never stretch, skew, or recolor the wordmark.**

The wordmark is set in Georgia 800 with a specific letter-spacing. Don't tighten it, don't loosen it, don't outline it. If you need a different visual treatment, use the vinyl mark.

✗ **Never put orange on a navy backplate without the underline anchor.**

Orange on navy is the brand's signature pairing — but only when grounded by the orange underline ornament. Orange text floating on navy without the underline reads as a UI mistake.

✗ **Never use realistic photography of people.**

The brand is built around editorial illustration. Realistic photos of people undermine the album-as-curriculum aesthetic and introduce consent/likeness issues. Use the abstract silhouette system instead.

✗ **Never use stock illustration libraries.**

Generic stock illustration ages the brand instantly. Every illustration on a MBA Rock surface should be original — generated or commissioned. See §06.

✗ **Never use jargon ("transform," "empower," "leverage," "synergy," "disrupt," "journey").**

These are the words operators stop reading at. If your sentence contains any of them, rewrite.

✗ **Never use a different connector in the co-brand lockup.**

The connector is always "×". Not "&", not "+", not "and", not the partner's house style.

✗ **Never publish without the wordmark or vinyl mark.**

Every surface — page, slide, social tile, email signature — carries one of the two marks. No unmarked artifacts in the wild.

S E C T I O N 1 2

Quick Reference

Print this page. Tape it to your monitor.

One-page brand card

NAME & MISSION

Name: MBA Rock — Musical Business Album (never "Music")

Mission: Make business mastery accessible to anyone who can listen, read, and ship.

COLORS

Navy #0B1F3A · **Orange** #F26B1F · **Cream** #FDFAF1

Supporting: Pale #F5F4ED · Ink #1a1a1a · Muted #5b6478

Functional: Signal Green #2ec07a · Alert Red #c5364c

TYPE

Display + body: Georgia / Fraunces, weight 800 for headlines, 400 for body

Functional: Inter — labels, buttons, captions, numbers

All-caps eyebrows: Inter 9pt 800 letter-spacing 4pt

VOICE

Direct. Specific. Memorable. Operator-flavored. Honest.

Avoid: transform, empower, leverage, synergy, journey, disrupt

MARKS

Wordmark · **Vinyl record** · **Orange underline** · **"x" co-brand connector**

NEVER

Free trials for D2C / cohorts (B2B 7-day eval seat is the only exception)

Call it an accredited MBA degree

Realistic photos of people · Stock illustrations · Generic jargon

WHERE THE ASSETS LIVE

This brand book: /Desktop/MBA Rock/MBA_Rock_BrandBook.pdf

Illustrations + figures: /Desktop/MBA Rock/textbook_build/figures/

Lockups + partner kit: /Desktop/MBA Rock/MBA_Rock_Partner_Term_Sheet_*

*Brand stewards: Josh Wark (CEO) · Jess Wark (Brand & Partnerships). Questions:
ceo@trufflebearoil.com*

MBA Rock

BRAND BOOK · FIRST EDITION

*"Most MBAs teach you to talk
about business.
MBA Rock teaches you to run one."*

